

Report on
By-Elections Held on
13 September 2025
Ward 8 of Makonde RDC
Ward 9 of Marondera Municipality
Ward 7 of Masvingo Municipality
and
Ward 16 of Nkayi RDC

ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

Executive Summary

1. The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of Section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.

2. Its functions are provided for in *Section 239* of the said Constitution.

3. Following the notification of the local authority vacancies which arose in Ward 16 of Nkayi RDC, Ward 8 of Makonde RDC, Ward 9 of Marondera Municipality and Ward 7 of Masvingo Municipality, the Commission issued **ZEC Notices on 1 and 31 July 2025** calling for by-elections to be held on 13 September 2025.

4. The Commission incurred expenses amounting to ZWG 6 000 000 for the by-elections.

5. The Commission conducted voter education exercises for the pre-nomination and pre-polling phases. The key messages for pre-nomination voter education focused on what caused the by-elections and the required qualifications for aspiring candidates. The pre-polling key messages focused on how to vote.

6. The Nomination Court to receive nomination papers for aspiring candidates to stand for election as councillor for Ward 16 Nkayi RDC sat on the 17th July 2025 while those for Ward 8 of Makonde RDC, Ward 9 of Marondera Municipality and Ward 7 of Masvingo Municipality sat on 14 August 2025.

The results of the Nomination Courts were as follows:

Persons Nominated for Election

	Local Authority	**Ward**	**Candidate**	**Sex**	**Sponsoring Party**
1	Nkayi RDC	16	Ndlovu Jabulani	M	Independent
2			Tshabalala Ronald	M	MDC
3			Tshabalala Sindisiwe	F	ZANU-PF
4			Tshuma Mandlenkosi	M	Mthwakazi Republic Party

1	Marondera Municipality	9	Machingauta Alice	F	MDC-T
2			Nyamundanda Charles Ndawona	M	ZANU PF

1	Masvingo Municipality	7	Mandati Tsungayi	F	Independent
2			Mataruse Prosper	M	MDC-T
3			Nyahunda Struggle	M	Independent
4			Shonhiwa Simbarashe	M	ZANU PF
5			Tiringindi Taruvinga Prosper	M	Independent

At the close of the sitting of the Ward 8 of Makonde Rural District Council nomination court Madhishi Bothwell of ZANU PF party was duly elected councillor for Ward 8 Makonde RDC unopposed with effect from 14 August 2025 as no other nomination papers were received.

7. Nyamundanda Charles Ndawona of ZANU PF party was duly elected councillor for Ward 9 of Marondera Municipality with effect from 20 August 2025 following the withdrawal of candidature by Alice Machingauta of MDC-T party.

8. A total of six thousand four hundred and fifty (6 450) ballot papers were printed for the local authority by-elections. This information was publicised in terms of the law.

9. The Commission established eleven (11) polling stations for voting purposes. This information was publicised in terms of the law.

10 The Commission used its own fleet of vehicles for the by-elections.

11. The training of electoral officers was conducted from 1 to 11 September 2025.

12. No applications for the accreditation of observers and media practitioners were received.

13. The by-elections for Ward 16 of Nkayi RDC and Ward 7 of Masvingo Municipality were held on 13 September 2025 and results were announced on the same day.

14. Below is a Schedule of local authority candidates that were elected after the conduct of polls: -

Local Authority	**Ward**	**Winner**	**Sex**	**Party**
Masvingo Municipality	7	Shonhiwa Simbarashe	M	ZANU PF
Nkayi RDC C	16	Tshabalala Sindisiwe	F	ZANU PF

15. The by-elections were held under peaceful conditions and no cases of politically motivated reports were received by the Commission.

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PART 1

THE ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

1.1 Composition

The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of the section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.

It is composed of a Chairperson appointed by the President after consultation with the Judicial Service Commission and the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders and eight other members appointed by the President from a list of not fewer than twelve nominees submitted by the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders.

At the time of the by-elections, the Commission consisted of a full board of nine members as follows: -

1.	Honourable Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba	-	Chairperson
2.	Ambassador Rodney Simukai Kiwa	-	Deputy Chairperson
3.	Mrs Abigail Millicent Mohadi- Ambrose	-	Commissioner
4.	Mr Shepherd Manhivi	-	Commissioner
5.	Ms Catherine Mpofu	-	Commissioner
6.	Mrs Rosewita Murutare	-	Commissioner
7.	Mr Jasper Mangwana	-	Commissioner
8.	Dr Janet Mbetu Nzvenga	-	Commissioner
9.	Dr Kudzai Shava	-	Commissioner

1.2 Functions of the Commission

The functions of the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission are provided for in section 239 of the Constitution as follows:

a. to prepare for, conduct and supervise –

   (i) elections to the office of President and to Parliament;

   (ii) elections to provincial and metropolitan councils and the governing bodies of local authorities;

   (iii) elections of Members of the National Council of Chiefs established by section 285; and

   (iv) referendums;

   and to ensure that those elections and referendums are conducted efficiently, freely, fairly, transparently and in accordance with the law,

b. to supervise elections of the President of the Senate and the Speaker and to ensure that these elections are conducted efficiently and in accordance with the law;

c. to register voters;

d. to compile voters' rolls and registers,

e. to ensure the proper custody and maintenance of voters rolls and registers;

f. to delimit constituencies, wards and other electoral boundaries;

g. to design, print and distribute ballot papers, approve the form of and procure ballot boxes, and establish and operate polling centres;

h. to conduct and supervise voter education;

i. to accredit observers of elections and referendums;

j. to give instructions to persons in the employment of the State or of a local authority for the purpose of ensuring the efficient, free, fair, proper and transparent conduct of any election or referendum; and

k. to receive and consider complaints from the public and to take such action in regard to the complaints as it considers appropriate.

1.3 Additional Functions

The Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*] in section 5 thereof provides for additional functions and powers of the Commission as follows:

a) undertaking and promoting research into electoral matters

b) developing expertise and the use of technology in regard to the electoral processes; and

c) promoting co-operation between Government, political parties and civil society in regard to elections; and

d) keeping the public informed about -

   i. the times and places where persons can register as voters and the progress of the voter registration exercise; and

   ii. the delimitation of wards, constituencies and other electoral boundaries, and

   iii. the location and boundaries of polling stations and when they are open for inspection; and

   iv. voters roll and the times and places at which they are open for inspection; and

   v. political parties and candidates contesting every election and;

   vi. voting; and

   vii. generally, all matters relating to the Commission's work and the electoral process; and

(d1) ensuring that gender is mainstreamed into electoral processes; and

(e) making recommendations to Parliament on appropriate ways to provide public financing for political parties.

PART 2

2.1 BUDGET

The Commission incurred expenses amounting to ZWG 6 000 000 for the 13 September 2025 by-elections.

2.2 Budget Control

The Commission applied all financial statutory guidelines as required by the law.

PART 3

3.1 PREPARATIONS FOR THE BY-ELECTIONS

3.2 ZEC Notices of the 1st and 31st of July 2025

Following the notification of the local authority vacancies which arose in Ward 16 of Nkayi RDC, Ward 8 of Makonde RDC, Ward 9 of Marondera Municipality and Ward 7 of Masvingo Municipality, the Commission issued **ZEC Notices on 1 and 31 July 2025** calling for by-elections to be held on 13 September 2025. The seats fell vacant by reason of death of the councillors who were duly elected during the 2023 Harmonised Elections. The Commission duly prepared for the by-elections in the Wards concerned.

3.3 Voter Education

The Commission conducted pre-nomination and pre-polling voter education for the said by-elections between the periods 5 to 9 August and 4 to 8 September 2025. The key messages for the pre-nomination phase centred on what had caused the by-elections and who qualified to be a candidate in the elections. The pre-polling voter education emphasised on notifying the electorate on the contesting candidates, correct documentation to carry, the polling date and times, the voting process and how to cast a vote, assisted and redirected voters and encouraging the electorate to go and vote.

The voter education teams used various methodologies to educate the electorate. These included the door-to-door visits, interaction with individuals and addressing of gatherings, use of posters, distribution of pamphlets and flyers and use of the Public Address (PA) System.

3.4 Nomination Court Results

The Nomination Court to receive nomination papers for aspiring candidates to stand for election as councillors for Ward 16 of Nkayi RDC sat on the 17th of July 2025 while those for Ward 8 of Makonde RDC, Ward 9 of Marondera Municipality and Ward 7 of Masvingo Municipality sat on the 14th of August 2025.

The following candidates were nominated for election at the close of the sitting of the Nomination Courts: -

Persons Nominated for Election

	Local Authority	Ward	Candidate	Sex	Sponsoring Party
1	Nkayi RDC	16	Ndlovu Jabulani	M	Independent
2			Tshabalala Ronald	M	MDC
3			Tshabalala Sindisiwe	F	ZANU-PF
4			Tshuma Mandlenkosi	M	Mthwakazi Republic Party
1	Marondera Municipality	9	Machingauta Alice	F	MDC-T
2			Nyamundanda Charles Ndawona	M	ZANU PF
1	Masvingo Municipality	7	Mandati Tsungayi	F	Independent
2			Mataruse Prosper	M	MDC-T
3			Nyahunda Struggle	M	Independent
4			Shonhiwa Simbarashe	M	ZANU PF
5			Tiringindi Taruvinga Prosper	M	Independent

Madhishi Bothwell of ZANU PF party was duly elected unopposed for Ward 8 of Makonde Rural District Council as no other nomination papers were received.

3.5 Withdrawal of Candidature

Nyamundanda Charles Ndawona of ZANU PF party was duly elected Councillor for Ward 9 of Marondera Municipality effective the 20th of August 2025 following the withdrawal of candidature by Machingauta Alice of MDC-T party.

3.6 Voter Registration

No voter registration was conducted prior to the sitting of the nomination courts owing to the fact that according to section 121A (3) of the Electoral Act [Chapter 2:13], the voters' roll closes on the day the vacancy arises for local authority by-elections.

3.7 Provision of Voters Rolls to Candidates

The contesting candidates were issued with copies of the voters' roll for their respective Wards. An analysable electronic voters' roll was placed at respective provincial, district and ward centres for access by the public.

3.8 Multiparty Liaison Committees

An average of two (2) Multiparty Liaison Committee meetings were held in the districts and Wards where by-elections were conducted. The meetings were successfully conducted. All the outstanding issues concerning the conduct of the by-elections were resolved.

3.9 Polling Stations

A total of eleven (11) polling stations were established in the Wards that had by-elections. Below is a breakdown of the polling stations:

Ser	Province	District	Local Authority	Ward	No. of Polling Stations
1	Masvingo	Masvingo	Masvingo Municipality	Ward 7	**7**
2	Mat North	Nkayi	Nkayi RDC	Ward 16	**4**
3	**Total**				**11**

3.10 Ballot Paper Printing

A total of six thousand four hundred and fifty ballot papers (**6 450**) were printed for the 13 September 2025 by-elections by the Minting and Printing Company of Zimbabwe (PMCZ). This information was publicised in terms of the law.

3.11 Transport

The Commission used its own vehicle fleet for the by-elections. Each polling station was allocated a vehicle and this made the process of deployment, transmission of results and decamping manageable.

3.12 Recruitment, Training and Deployment of Electoral Officers

Personnel to conduct the by-elections were drawn from the host provinces that is Masvingo and Matabeleland North Provinces, the Civil Service Commission and the local authorities concerned. The recruitment of Ward Elections Officers and their deputies was done on time and same were trained between 4 and 5 September 2025. The training of Presiding Officers was conducted on the 7th and 8th of September 2025 while the Polling Officers were trained between the 10th and 11th of September 2025.

Deployment of electoral officers took place prior to their training sessions. Training for polling officers was done at polling station level. The Zimbabwe Republic Police (ZRP) officers were deployed alongside electoral staff to provide security. The setting up of polling stations and rehearsals were done a day before polling.

3.13 Accreditation of Observers and Media Personnel

No applications for accreditation to observe the elections were received by the Commission.

PART 4

4.1 CONDUCT OF ELECTION – POLLING

4.2 Polling

Polling took place on 13 September 2025 commencing from 0700 hours and ending at 1900 hours. Due regard was given to the provision that no voter in the queue of persons waiting to vote as at 1900 hours would be turned away.

Every polling station was staffed by electoral officers as well as election agents, observers and police details that provided security and performed other duties as provided by the law.

Only one (1) distinctly marked ballot box for Ward by-election was set up in each polling station.



4.3 Assisted Voters

The below table shows the number by gender of persons assisted in the wards during the by-elections: -

Local Authority	Assisted Voters		
	Female	Male	**Total**
Masvingo Municipality Ward 7	17	9	**26**
Nkayi RDC Ward 16	18	6	**24**
Total	**35**	**15**	**50**

The illiterate, the elderly and the visually challenged voters who were not able to vote without assistance were assisted by persons of their choice in compliance with the law. A person who did not bring an assistant was assisted by the Presiding Officer in the presence of two other officers and the police officer on duty.

4.4 Turned Away Voters

The two Wards had a total of one hundred and sixteen (116) turned away voters broken down as follows: -

Local Authority	Turned Away Voters		Total
	Female	Male	
Masvingo Municipality Ward 7	18	17	**35**
Nkayi RDC Ward 16	13	`15	**28**
Total	**31**	**32**	**63**

The reasons for turning away voters were non-possession of identity cards and not appearing on the voters' roll among others.

4.5 Verification and Counting

The counting of the votes was preceded by the verification of ballots which process was administered at polling station level by the Presiding Officers in the presence of candidates and election agents present. The verification and counting of polling station results was completed on 13 September 2025.



4.6 Results of Poll

The Ward Elections Officers declared the results of the poll at the respective Ward Collation Centres. The polling station results were posted outside the polling stations and the collated results at the Ward Collation Centres.

The summary of the results for the by-elections was as follows:

Local Authority	Ward	Candidates	Sex	Party	Votes	
Masvingo	7	Mandati Tsungayi	F	Independent	58	
		Mataruse Prosper	M	MDC-T	11	
		Nyahunda Struggle	M	Independent	192	
		Shonhiwa Simbarashe	M	ZANU PF	703	*Winner*
		Tiringindi Taruvinga	M	Independent	119	
		Total Valid Votes Cast			**1083**	
		Total Votes Rejected			**4**	
		Ballot Paper Unaccounted for			**0**	
		Total Votes Cast			**1087**	
		Voter Population			**4642**	
		Percentage Poll			**23.4%**	

Local Authority	Ward	Candidates	Sex	Party	Votes	
Nkayi RDC	16	Ndlovu Jabulani	M	Independent	128	
		Tshabalala Ronald	M	MDC	69	
		Tshabalala Sindisiwe	F	ZANU-PF	278	*Winner*
		Tshuma Mandlenkosi	M	MRP	10	
		Total Valid Votes Cast			**485**	
		Total Votes Rejected			**7**	
		Ballot Paper Unaccounted for			**0**	
		Total Votes Cast			**492**	
		Voter Population			**1435**	
		Percentage Poll			**34.3%**	

Comparison of 2023 Harmonised Elections and 2025 By-elections Voter Turn-out

		Voter Population		Percentage Poll	
Local Authority	**Ward**	**2023**	**2025**	**2023**	**2025**
Masvingo Municipality	7	4 647	4 642	63.6%	23.4%
Nkayi RDC	16	1 449	1 435	51.8%	34.3%

4.7 The Environment

The elections were held under calm and peaceful conditions. The Commission did not receive any report on politically motivated incidents.

PART 5

5.1 OBSERVATIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSION

The Commission made observations and recommendations as presented below: -

5.2 Budget

Observation

There is a notable difference between the budgetary requirements requested and the amounts released by Treasury.

Recommendation

Adequate and timeous funding is critical in the implementation of polling processes.

5.3 Payment of Allowances in Local Currency

Observation

The advance allowances were paid in local currency while many local shops traded in foreign currencies especially in the Matabeleland provinces.

Recommendation

There is need for partial payment of allowances in foreign currency to cushion electoral officers from such eventualities in affected areas.

5.4 Conclusion

Generally, the 13 September 2025 by-elections were conducted in a peaceful manner. The Commission consulted and worked in collaboration with its stakeholders throughout the election period ensuring that the process was inclusive and transparent.

The Commission was satisfied that the 13 September 2025 by-elections were conducted in a manner and under conditions that allowed voters to freely express their will.

Signed: ……. Date: ……....

Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba

ZEC Chairperson

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